

NexaWorks

Delivered properly, supported permanently

Replacement of the Library Management System

Greenfield City Library Service operates a central library and eleven branch libraries serving approximately 184,000 registered members. The present library management system was commissioned in 2006, is no longer supported by its original vendor, and cannot support self-service borrowing, online renewals, or consolidated reporting across branches. The Service invites proposals for a replacement covering catalogue management, membership, circulation (borrowing, returns, renewals, reservations), inter-branch transfers, overdue fines, and public search.

Submitted to	Greenfield City Library Service
RFP reference	GCLS/RFP/2026/014
Submission date	2026-09-09
Proposed duration	7 months

FICTIONAL DOCUMENT -- prepared for an academic exercise. Greenfield City Library Service, the suppliers and all references named in this document are invented. No real organisation is described.

1. Executive Summary and Understanding of the Requirement

NexaWorks proposes a seven month delivery of a replacement library management system for Greenfield City Library Service, followed by a support relationship designed to last the life of the platform. We have read the requirement as three problems rather than one: the Service must leave an unsupported system, it must give members self-service, and it must stop reconciling eleven branches by overnight batch.

Our proposal is deliberately balanced. We are not the cheapest respondent and we have not proposed the shortest timeline. What we have concentrated on is the part of this programme that most commonly fails: the transition itself, and the twelve months after go-live when branch staff are learning a new system while serving the public.

- Seven month delivery with a staged branch rollout, not a single big-bang cutover
- Two pilot branches live eight weeks before the remaining ten
- Twelve weeks of post-go-live hypercare with on-site presence in the first four
- 80 hours per year of included change, so small improvements never need a change request

2. Proposed Solution and Technical Approach

The platform is a cloud-hosted application built on our established library product, configured and extended for the Service. It runs on managed container infrastructure with a managed PostgreSQL database, automated daily backups with 35 day retention, and a tested restore procedure exercised quarterly.

Circulation, catalogue, membership, reservations and inter-branch transfers are delivered as configured modules. Public search is delivered as a responsive web interface with WCAG 2.2 AA accessibility conformance, which we consider non-negotiable for a public library service and have priced accordingly. Integration covers the existing RFID gates and kiosks over SIP2, the council payment gateway for fines, SAML

single sign-on for staff, and OpenAthens for the Service's subscribed e-resources.

Reporting is delivered as a set of twenty predefined operational reports agreed during discovery, plus a self-service query builder for branch managers. All reports draw from a read replica, so reporting load cannot affect circulation performance at the counter.

- Managed containers and managed PostgreSQL; daily backups, 35 day retention, quarterly restore tests
- WCAG 2.2 AA conformance on the public interface, independently audited before go-live
- SIP2, payment gateway, SAML single sign-on and OpenAthens integrations all in scope
- Reporting from a read replica so it cannot slow down the issue desk

3. Implementation Plan, Team and Milestones

Seven months, seven phases, with a staged rollout. Two pilot branches go live in week 20; the remaining ten follow in three waves once the pilot has run a full month including an end-of-month fines cycle. Every phase has a defined exit criterion signed by a named person on both sides; no phase begins before the previous one is signed off.

Phase	Weeks	Exit criterion	Accountable
1. Discovery	1-4	Requirements catalogue and loan rules signed off	Business Analyst
2. Configuration	5-12	Configured system demonstrated to branch champions	Implementation Lead
3. Migration build	7-16	Two rehearsals complete, variance under 0.1%	Data Lead
4. Integration	11-18	SIP2, payments, SSO and OpenAthens tested end to end	Integration Lead
5. UAT and training	17-19	UAT signed off; 46 staff trained across 12 sites	Test and Training Lead
6. Pilot go-live	20-24	2 pilot branches live through a full month-end	Project Manager
7. Full rollout	25-30	All 12 sites live; 12 weeks hypercare begins	Project Manager

The team is nine people with a named individual accountable for each phase exit. A RACI matrix covering all 38 programme activities is provided in Annex B and forms part of the contract. Governance is a weekly delivery call, a fortnightly steering group, and a single shared risk register reviewed at every steering group with joint ownership of every open risk.

We hold a two week contingency buffer between phase 6 and phase 7, unallocated and visible in the plan. If the pilot surfaces problems we absorb them there rather than compressing training or testing later.

4. Commercial Proposal

Fixed price for implementation. The annual charge includes an 80 hour continuous improvement pool so routine small changes do not require a commercial conversation.

One-off implementation charges	Amount
Discovery and requirements workshops	\$38,000
Platform configuration	\$84,000
Development and customisation	\$72,000

One-off implementation charges	Amount
Data migration and reconciliation	\$54,000
Integration: RFID, payments, SSO, e-resources	\$40,000
Training, documentation and hypercare	\$24,000
Total one-off charges	\$312,000

Recurring annual charges	Amount
Cloud hosting	\$26,000
Support and maintenance, extended hours	\$24,000
Continuous improvement pool, 80 hours	\$8,000
Total per year	\$58,000

Total cost of ownership	\$312,000 + 3 x \$58,000 = \$486,000
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Figures are quoted over a 3 year contract term and exclude sales tax.

Commercial assumptions:

- Two named Service staff available two days per week during discovery and UAT
- Branch champions released for two days of training each
- Legacy extract supplied within six weeks of contract signature
- Unused continuous improvement hours do not roll over between years
- Prices exclude applicable sales tax and are valid for 120 days

5. Security, Compliance and Risk Controls

NexaWorks holds ISO 27001 certification and operates a documented secure development lifecycle including peer review, dependency scanning and static analysis on every change. Member data is encrypted at rest and in transit using TLS 1.2 or above. Role-based access control is configured to the Service's own role structure during discovery, and all administrative actions are logged to an append-only audit table.

An independent penetration test is carried out before pilot go-live and the report shared with the Service. Data is held in-country. We support the Service's retention policy for borrowing history, with a configurable pseudonymisation period, and provide a subject access request export tool so member requests can be answered by library staff without a call to support.

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation
Pilot reveals workflow gaps	High	Two week contingency buffer held between pilot and full rollout
Legacy member records duplicated	High	De-duplication report produced at rehearsal 1; Service adjudicates before rehearsal 2
Branch staff under-trained at go-live	Medium	Branch champion model; 12 weeks hypercare, on-site for the first 4
Month-end fines cycle behaves unexpectedly	Medium	Pilot deliberately runs through a full month-end before wider rollout

6. Support Model, Experience and References

Support runs 07:00 to 19:00 Monday to Saturday, matching library opening hours rather than office hours, with on-call cover for priority 1 incidents outside those times. Response targets are 30 minutes for priority 1, two hours for priority 2, and one business day for priority 3. Resolution targets are four hours, one business day and ten business days respectively. Service credits are defined in the draft service agreement at Annex C.

Every customer has a named Service Delivery Manager and a named technical escalation contact. Reviews are monthly for the first year and quarterly thereafter. A joint improvement backlog is maintained and prioritised by the Service at each review; the 80 hour pool is drawn from it.

NexaWorks was founded in 2012 and employs 165 staff, 40 of them in the library and cultural services practice. References:

- Ashford Vale Libraries, 14 branches, 205,000 members, delivered 2024, staged rollout across four waves with no unplanned downtime at any branch
- Kestrel District Council, 6 branches, delivered 2022, still supported by the same service delivery manager
- Port Ellis Library Trust, 3 sites, delivered 2021, migrated from the same 2006-era product family the Service currently operates